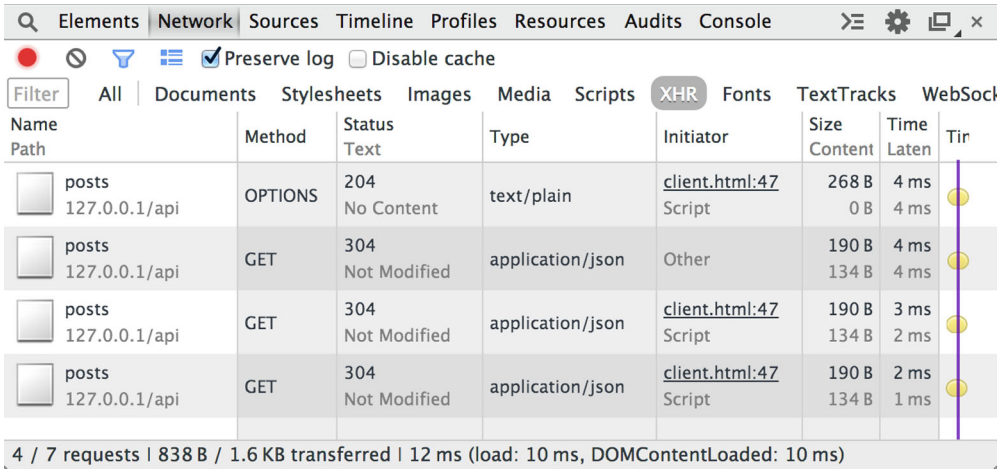


Figure 4.22 Multiple `GET` requests to the same URL using the preflight result cache

While you can examine network traffic to see whether a preflight request was sent, there is no way to view the contents of the preflight request cache. The cache is a black box that is maintained internally by the browser. But you can have some control over how long items stay in the cache by using the Access-Control-Max-Age header.

SETTING THE CACHE TIME WITH ACCESS-CONTROL-MAX-AGE

CORS gives servers some control over how long a preflight response is cached through the Access-Control-Max-Age response header. The Access-Control-Max-Age header indicates how long, in seconds, a response can stay in the cache.

The following listing modifies the sample app to cache preflight requests for two minutes. This means that after the first preflight response is cached, the browser will check the cache before every request to the same URL for the next two minutes. After those two minutes are up, the browser will send a preflight request again.

Listing 4.10 Adding the Access-Control-Max-Age response header

```
var handleCors = function(req, res, next) {
  res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Origin', 'http://localhost:1111');
  if (isPreflight(req)) {
    res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Methods', 'GET, DELETE');
    res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Headers',
            'Timezone-Offset, Sample-Source');
    res.set('Access-Control-Max-Age', '120');
    res.status(204).end();
    return;
  }
  next();
};
```

Setting cache expiration to two minutes

The Access-Control-Max-Age value is only a suggestion for how long an item should be cached. Browsers may cache for a shorter amount of time. Firefox doesn't allow